

# Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

## Potential Problems?

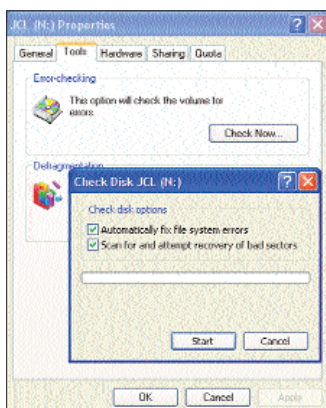
**Q** I created a Windows XP bootable CD with SP2 as was described in the instructions given in "Take a Crack" of Digit March 2005. First, I installed Windows 98 SE in the F: drive. After completing the installation, I installed Windows XP SP2 in the C: drive. During the installation, after the first reboot, I got an error message saying that files SV-262e1.png, SV-262e3.png, and SV-262e4.png were missing. I have not encountered any problems after the installation. I want to know whether there are any potential problems and how I should solve them.

Prajwal, Bangalore

**A** You are experiencing the problem because your CD is not written properly. Due to this, some part of the installation works properly but the other does not, as some files have not been written accurately to the CD. There are many reasons for this to happen: running other programs while the CD is being written, an anti-virus software running in the background, bad quality media or even a faulty CD writer. You will need to rewrite the CD and this time, try to avoid any of the above and if possible, try burning to a different brand of media at a lower speed.

## Will defragmenting my hard drive speed it up?

**Q** I have an AMD 2400+, 512 MB RAM, ASUS GeForce4 MX 440 64 MB, 60 GB Samsung hard drive. My computer was absolutely fine until I decided to connect my hard drive to a friend's computer. I managed to connect the hard drive, but messed up on the jumper settings. Eventually, I just gave up and got the hard drive back. Ever since this episode, I have recollected the jumper settings and even got XP to work. But, my computer slowed down a great deal. In fact, all hard drive operations were painfully slow. I even did a complete format but that didn't help either. I reinstalled



Run check disk to correct hard disk errors

XP with SP2 but the computer continued to be sluggish. I returned to normal XP without any service pack but the hard drive is still very slow. Copying files takes a very long time. What is wrong with my PC? Will a defrag solve it?

Arun, Via e-mail

**A** In all probability, your hard drive has developed bad sectors. This could have happened while it was kept out of your PC. Hence, when Windows XP loads and tries to access these bad sector areas on the hard drive, it is not able to access any data there, and your system comes to a standstill.

You must run a check disk on your drives in order to mark these areas as bad sectors and correct this problem. To do this, open 'My Computer', right-click on 'C:' and click on 'Properties'. Click on 'Tools' and click on 'Check Now'. In the Check Disk options, check the options 'Automatically fix file system errors' and 'Scan for and attempt recovery of bad sectors'. Although this will fix your problem temporarily, you should note that bad sectors point to a failing and unreliable hard drive and tend to increase. You should replace it with a new one soon.

## Audio Formats in DVD

**Q** In AVI to DVD software, while converting VCDs to DVD format, the audio stream box remains blank. It doesn't show the formats. VCDs are generally 'DAT' files. Are AVI and DAT the same? How should I convert VCDs to DVD format and vice-versa?

Pratul Shrestha, Kathmandu

**A** Audio streams of a DVD usually consist of six audio channels and are Dolby Digital encoded. To decode the audio, you need to have the appropriate AC3 filters to be installed. In the absence of these Codecs, the DVD audio cannot be decoded and hence you are unable to see anything in the audio stream box. You can download the free AC3 filters from [www.ac3filter.sourceforge.net](http://www.ac3filter.sourceforge.net). Alternatively, you may also download and install DVD players such as Cyberlink PowerDVD 6 from [www.cyberlink.com](http://www.cyberlink.com) or InterVideo WinDVD 7 from [www.intervideo.com](http://www.intervideo.com).

The DAT format is different from AVI. DAT format is an implementation of MPEG-1 format whereas AVI is the native video format used by Windows. You may use software such as NeroVision Express from [www.nero.com](http://www.nero.com) to convert VCD to DVD and vice-versa. You may also use TMPGEnc from [www.tmpegenc.net/e\\_download.html](http://www.tmpegenc.net/e_download.html) to do the same.

## Splinter Cell Problems

**Q** I have an AMD 64 3200+, 1 GB 400 MHz RAM, an MSI motherboard and a GeForce 6600 256 MB (PCIe) card. After installing Splinter Cell Pandora Tomorrow, I get an error saying "NO Non power-of-two render target support detected". No one seems to know how to solve it.

G Natarajan, Via e-mail